

Jewish Scene

Former chief rabbi urges Jews to use money, not chickens, for Yom Kippur kapparot ritual

Rabbi Yitzhak Yosef says the traditional ritual should be performed with 35 shekels when proper poultry care and supervised slaughter cannot be guaranteed, warning that mistreating birds could violate Jewish law



Shilo Freid | 09.15.26 | 15:14

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Former Chief Rabbi Yitzhak Yosef ruled in a letter published Tuesday that the [kapparot ritual should not be performed using chickens](#). "Where there is concern about causing suffering to animals, the kapparot custom should be observed with money, in the amount equivalent to the cost of a chicken — 35 shekels," he wrote.

Ahead of Yom Kippur, which falls at the beginning of next week, Yosef said the kapparot custom cannot come at the expense of the prohibition against [causing suffering to animals](#). When proper conditions for keeping the birds and supervised kosher slaughter cannot be guaranteed, he said, the ritual should not be performed with chickens because doing so could violate the prohibition against animal cruelty.



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